

Power BI Governance Guide

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Important: This guide provides organization-level configuration guidance aligned with the governance framework in this repository. Always follow Microsoft's official Power BI documentation for product-specific instructions, as features and licensing tiers (Pro, Premium, Fabric) change features available.

Purpose

This guide defines how [Organization Name] governs Power BI as a consumption-layer platform: workspace structure, certified datasets, row-level security, and lineage integration with the broader data catalog.

1. Pre-Implementation Checklist

- ☐ Data Classification Scheme finalized, with mapping to Power BI sensitivity labels
- ☐ Power BI tenant settings reviewed and aligned with Data Privacy & Security Policy
- ☐ Workspace structure plan defined (see Section 2)
- ☐ BI Platform Administrator role assigned

2. Workspace and Content Organization

Governance Concept	Power BI Equivalent
Business Domain	Workspace (one per domain or major business function)
Trusted Data Source	Certified/Promoted Dataset
Classification Level	Sensitivity Label

Governance Concept	Power BI Equivalent
Report/Dashboard Asset	Catalog entry of type "Report"/"Dashboard"

Recommended structure: One workspace per major business domain, with separate Dev/Test/Prod workspaces where Premium capacity is available, using deployment pipelines for promotion.

3. Sensitivity Labeling

- ☐ Configure Microsoft Purview Information Protection (or equivalent) sensitivity labels matching the four classification levels: Public, Internal, Confidential, Restricted
- ☐ Enforce mandatory labeling on all published datasets and reports
- ☐ Configure label inheritance so labels propagate from dataset to dependent reports/dashboards
- ☐ Audit label application monthly; flag unlabeled content for remediation

4. Certified and Promoted Datasets

- ☐ Establish a certification process: only datasets reviewed by a Business Data Steward and validated against the data catalog's quality scorecard may be marked "Certified"
- ☐ Discourage report-level data import from uncertified sources; route analysts to the certified dataset library
- ☐ Maintain a register of certified datasets linking each to its source `data\_assets` entry in the catalog

5. Row-Level Security (RLS) and Access Control

- ☐ Define RLS roles aligned to the classification and need-to-know principles in the Data Privacy & Security Policy
- ☐ Test RLS roles against representative user accounts before publishing
- ☐ Document RLS role definitions alongside the dataset's catalog entry for audit purposes
- ☐ Review workspace access quarterly; remove stale access per the Data Request Workflow process

6. Lineage and Metadata Integration

- ☐ Enable Power BI's built-in lineage view within workspaces to visualize dataflow → dataset → report → dashboard relationships
- ☐ Where supported, integrate Power BI lineage metadata (via Microsoft Purview or API) into the central data catalog, extending lineage from source systems through to the consumption layer
- ☐ For datasets not covered by automated lineage capture, document relationships manually in Data_Lineage_Mapping_Templates.xlsx

7. Data Quality at the Reporting Layer

- ☐ Configure dataset refresh failure alerts routed to the responsible Technical Data Steward

- ☐ Apply Timeliness quality checks (refresh success, data freshness) consistent with the Data Quality Standards
- ☐ Periodically reconcile key report figures against the data warehouse source of truth to catch silent calculation drift

8. Governance Roles in Power BI

Governance Role	Power BI Role
BI Platform Administrator	Tenant/Power BI Administrator
Technical Data Steward	Workspace Admin / Dataset Owner
Business Data Steward	Member (certification reviewer)
Report Developers	Contributor
Business Users	Viewer

9. Self-Service Analytics Guardrails

- ☐ Publish guidance for self-service report builders referencing the data catalog for approved sources (see End User Awareness Materials)
- ☐ Provide a "fast-track" lightweight review for low-risk, low-classification self-service reports to avoid bottlenecking innovation
- ☐ Require Confidential/Restricted data reports to go through full governance review before broad distribution

10. Rollout Checklist

- ☐ Pilot domain workspace structured, certified datasets published, RLS tested
- ☐ Sensitivity labeling enforced tenant-wide
- ☐ Lineage visibility validated from source system through to dashboard
- ☐ Report developers and business users briefed per the Stakeholder Communication Plan

Document Control:

- This is a template document requiring customization for your specific Power BI licensing tier and tenant configuration
- Always consult official Microsoft Power BI documentation for product-specific steps
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